

TIM MACY

WRITER / STORYTELLER / IDEA PERSON

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Original ideas. Different forms. Actual audiences.



The Brass Teapot: A New Musical creative team

ONE STRANGE IDEA -> SHORT STORY -> FEATURE FILM -> STAGE MUSICAL

That evolution is probably the cleanest explanation of how I work: find the thing with life in it, keep asking what else it can become, and rewrite until the form catches up with the idea.

THE BRASS TEAPOT

ORIGINAL STORY / SCREENPLAY / FEATURE FILM / MUSICAL BOOK

A broke young couple discovers a brass teapot that produces money when people feel pain. The solution to their financial problems gets darker as the object demands more - and different - kinds of suffering.

My role: screenplay and co-story credit on the feature film; book co-writer and producer on the stage musical.

One concept has now lived in radically different forms: my original fiction, a produced feature film, and a stage musical rebuilt for live performance with a collaborative creative team and an alt-pop-rock score.

Selected milestones: The feature premiered at the Toronto International Film Festival in 2012. The musical was selected for the 2024 Chicago Musical Theatre Festival and NAMT's 36th Annual Festival of New Musicals; the current draft received a March 2026 private NYC workshop co-produced by Ogunquit Playhouse.

[Musical site](#) | [Original short story](#) | [IMDb](#) | [Listen to demos](#)

LOST CHILD

FEATURE FILM / CO-SCREENWRITER

A darker piece of work: an Ozark-set mystery thriller drawing on folklore, isolation and the uneasy space between belief and fear.

The voice, atmosphere and dramatic engine are very different from The Brass Teapot: an Ozark-set mystery thriller built around folklore, isolation and uncertainty.

Festival life: The film was an official selection at Heartland, Bentonville and Sarasota. It won Best Narrative Feature at Kansas City FilmFest International; Leven Rambin received Best Actress at the Taormina Film Fest.

[IMDb - Lost Child](#) | [Trailer / video](#)

WHEN THE WORK LEAVES YOUR HANDS

One of the stranger pleasures of writing is discovering what happens to a piece after it belongs to an audience. Years after the film, students performed a scene from The Brass Teapot for speech and debate competition. I love that: words written for one medium becoming useful to someone in another.

[Student performance](#) | [Interview / background](#) | [Mystery Tribune feature](#)

OTHER WRITING

Congressional speechwriting. Wrote speeches and public communications for the Office of Congresswoman Nancy Boyda, translating policy and background material into language meant to be heard and understood.

Creative production. Created educational media, scripts and digital storytelling with multidisciplinary teams at @dolescent.

Published work. "Prehistory," Silent Voices (2005); "The Good Nights When My Father Died," Reed Magazine (2007), later reprinted in Last Writes (2009).

Writing development. Years teaching composition and working one-on-one with graduate writers taught me how to give useful notes, protect a writer's voice and make the work stronger without making the room precious about it.

THE DYING WESTERN

ORIGINAL STORY • SCREENPLAY • AWARD-WINNING SHORT FILM

Another idea that escaped the page.

Before *The Brass Teapot* made the leap from fiction to film, my published short story “The Good Nights When My Father Died” became the 2009 short film *The Dying Western*.

The story follows Howard, an aspiring actor chasing his dream of becoming the next John Wayne while finding most of his success playing dying extras in Westerns. I received story and screenplay credit; Michael Kortlander co-wrote the screenplay and directed.

SELECTED RECOGNITION

- Audience Choice Award - Drama (tie) - Route 66 Film Festival (2009)

[IMDb - The Dying Western](#)

LEAVES OF WORDS

RESEARCH • PLAYWRITING • DOCUMENTARY-INSPIRED STORYTELLING

How do you tell a true story when nobody knows how it ends?

In 2006, I wrote *Leaves of Words*, a full-length play about the unresolved disappearance of 17-year-old Randy Leach, who vanished after attending a party near Linwood, Kansas, in 1988.

I spent more than a year developing the work. I interviewed Randy's family and sorted through hundreds of police reports, articles and other documents, then shaped that sprawling and contradictory material into a dramatic narrative.

Rather than inventing a definitive answer, the play moved through competing possibilities from the perspective of a father living with uncertainty. KU's English Alternative Theatre produced the play in Lawrence in October 2006; Randy's parents planned to attend all three performances.

THE CREATIVE CHALLENGE

Research deeply. Respect real people. Find a narrative inside an enormous amount of information without pretending the unanswered parts are answered.

SELECTED EARLY STAGE WORK

Leaves of Words was presented at KU English Alternative Theatre's Festival 39 in 2007. My earlier play *Attack of the Asians* was presented at Festival 35 in 2003 and was also performed at the Kennedy Center in Washington, D.C.

[Read the 2006 Lawrence Journal-World feature](#)

[English Alternative Theatre production history](#)